

Word family: **attention / attentive / attentively / inattentive / inattention**

Base word: attention

Related forms: attentive, attentively, inattentive, inattentively, inattention

Useful extensions: attention span, attention to detail, attention-grabbing, attention-seeking

Important expressions: catch someone's attention, pay attention, draw/call attention to, give something attention, at attention

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞), with adjective/adverb family members

Your sentence:

> "...the ad immediately **caught my attention**."

A full family sweep shows that **attention** has one strong central idea—**mental or practical focus directed toward someone or something**—but several genuinely useful extensions:

1. mental concentration;
2. causing someone to notice;
3. careful consideration;
4. care/treatment given to someone or something;
5. military **attention**;
6. plural **attentions** = persistent social/romantic interest;
7. technical **attention** in AI/machine learning.

Meaning in your passage

Here:

> **caught my attention**

means:

made me notice the advertisement and directed my interest toward it.

繁體中文: **令我立刻注意到它，並把我的注意力吸引到廣告上**

Natural translation:

> "...so the ad immediately caught my attention."

「.....所以那則廣告立刻**吸引了我的注意力／引起了我的注意**。」

So here:

****attention = 人的注意力、關注焦點****

and:

****catch someone's attention = 成功令某人注意到某人／某事****

1. ****attention = mental focus (注意力／精神) — 注意力; 專注****

This is the central meaning.

****Meaning:**** The mental concentration you direct toward someone or something.

Practice 1

> “The noise made it difficult to keep my ****attention**** on the report.”

「噪音令我很難把****注意力****保持在報告上。」

Practice 2

> “The teacher asked for the students’ full ****attention****.”

「老師要求學生****全神貫注／集中全部注意力****。」

****attention = 人在某一刻把思考、感官和精神集中在某個對象上的狀態****

2. ****catch / attract someone's attention (人／事物) — 吸引注意; 引起注意****

This is your original construction.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The ad immediately ****caught my attention****.”

「那則廣告立刻****吸引了我的注意力****。」

Practice 4

> “The unusual design ****caught my attention****.”

「那個不尋常的設計**引起了我的注意**。」

Practice 5

> “Bright colours are often used to **attract attention**.”

「鮮艷的顏色經常被用來**吸引注意力**。」

catch/attract attention = 令某人開始留意某人／某事, 把注意力轉向它

3. **pay attention to + person/thing/information (人／事／資訊) — 注意; 留意; 專心聽／看**

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 6

> “Please **pay attention to** the instructions.”

「請**仔細留意／專心聽**指示。」

Practice 7

> “You need to **pay attention to** the details.”

「你需要**仔細留意細節**。」

pay attention to = 主動把注意力集中在某個對象上, 以免錯過重要資訊

Important:

> **pay attention to** 

not:

> *pay attention on* 

4. **draw / call attention to + issue/detail (議題／細節) — 提請注意; 使人關注**

Meaning: To deliberately make people notice something.

Practice 8

> “The report **draws attention to** several safety problems.”

「這份報告**提請大家注意**幾個安全問題。」

Practice 9

> “She **called attention to** an error in the figures.”

「她**指出並提醒大家注意**數據中的一個錯誤。」

draw/call attention to = 有意令其他人注意某項原本可能被忽略的事情

This is different from **catch attention**:

* **catch attention** → naturally attracts notice

* **draw/call attention to** → deliberately directs notice

5. **attention** = careful consideration (事情／議題) — 關注; 重視; 仔細考慮

Here, **attention** is not just momentary noticing.

It means sustained consideration or effort.

Practice 10

> “The issue requires immediate **attention**.”

「這個問題需要立即**關注和處理**。」

Practice 11

> “The proposal deserves careful **attention**.”

「這項建議值得**仔細考慮和重視**。」

attention = 對某件重要事情投入足夠時間、思考和處理, 以確保它得到妥善處置

6. ****attention to detail**(工作／品質) — 對細節的重視;細心程度******

A very common workplace expression.

Practice 12

> “The job requires excellent ****attention to detail****.”

「這份工作要求非常高的****細節觀察力和細心程度****。」

Practice 13

> “Her ****attention to detail**** improved the quality of the final report.”

「她****對細節的仔細重視****提升了最終報告的品質。」

****attention to detail = 對細小但重要的資訊保持高度留意, 避免錯漏****

7. ****attention = care/service given to a person**(照料／服務) — 照顧;照料;服務******

****Meaning:**** Care, help, or service directed toward someone's needs.

Practice 14

> “The patient needs constant ****attention****.”

「這名病人需要持續的****照料和看護****。」

Practice 15

> “The staff gave us excellent ****attention**** throughout our stay.”

「住宿期間, 職員一直給我們很周到的****照顧和服務****。」

****attention = 為滿足某人的需要而給予的照料、協助或服務****

8. ****medical attention**(醫療) — 醫療照顧;診治******

A very important established expression.

Practice 16

> “The injury requires immediate medical **attention**.”

「這個傷勢需要立即接受**醫療處理／診治**。」

Practice 17

> “Seek medical **attention** if the symptoms become worse.”

「如果症狀惡化，應尋求**醫療協助／診治**。」

medical attention = 由醫療人員提供的檢查、照顧或治療

This is not simply “paying attention medically.”

It is an established care/treatment use.

9. **attention = maintenance/repair needed by something (設備／事情) — 處理；維修；照料**

The object receiving attention can be non-human.

Practice 18

> “The engine needs urgent **attention**.”

「引擎需要立即**檢查和維修處理**。」

Practice 19

> “Several areas of the building require **attention**.”

「大樓有幾個地方需要**處理／修繕**。」

attention = 對有問題的物件或情況作出必要檢查、維修或處理

This grows naturally from “careful consideration/care.”

10. **Attention! (命令／公告) — 注意！；請注意！**

Here, **attention** can function as a standalone call or command.

Practice 20

> “**Attention, please.**” The train will depart shortly.”

「**請注意。** 火車即將開出。」

Practice 21

> “**Attention!**” This area is closed to the public.”

「**注意！** 此區域不對公眾開放。」

Attention! = 用來立即要求所有人集中注意, 通常出現在公告、警告或正式指示中

11. **at attention** (軍事姿勢) — 立正

A genuinely specialized but common established expression.

Practice 22

> “The soldiers stood **at attention**.”

「士兵們**立正站好**。」

Practice 23

> “The officer ordered the group to come **to attention**.”

「軍官命令隊伍**立正**。」

at attention = 身體挺直、姿勢固定, 處於正式軍事立正姿勢

This is not ordinary mental attention.

12. **attentions** (複數) = persistent social/romantic interest — 殷勤; 追求; 示好

This is a genuinely distinct plural use.

Practice 24

> “She was uncomfortable with his persistent ****attentions****.”

「她對他持續不斷的****殷勤示好／追求****感到不自在。」

Practice 25

> “He tried to avoid the unwanted ****attentions**** of the press.”

「他試圖避開媒體那些他不想要的****持續關注和追逐****。」

****attentions** = 對某人持續而明顯的關注、殷勤或追求；可帶浪漫意味，也可指令人不想要的密集關注

Important:

> ****attention**** = 注意力／關注

> ****attentions**** = 持續的殷勤、追求或密集關注

13. ****attention span**(認知／學習) — 注意力持續時間

A very useful compound.

Practice 26

> “Young children often have shorter ****attention spans****.”

「年幼兒童的****注意力持續時間****通常較短。」

Practice 27

> “Constant notifications can affect your ****attention span****.”

「持續的通知可能影響你的****持續專注能力****。」

****attention span** = 一個人在注意力開始明顯分散之前，能持續專注於某件事情的時間長度

14. ****attention-grabbing** = designed to attract notice — 吸睛的；引人注目的

A very relevant advertising extension.

Practice 28

> “The commercial used an **attention-grabbing** opening.”

「這則廣告用了非常**吸睛**的開場。」

Practice 29

> “The packaging is colourful and **attention-grabbing**.”

「包裝色彩鮮艷而且非常**引人注目**。」

attention-grabbing = 特別設計成能迅速吸引別人注意力的

This is especially useful in your advertising lesson.

15. **attention-seeking** = trying to attract notice, often excessively — 刻意博取注意的; 愛出風頭的

This usually has a negative tone.

Practice 30

> “His behaviour seemed **attention-seeking**.”

「他的行為看起來像是**刻意博取別人注意**。」

Practice 31

> “The post was criticized as **attention-seeking**.”

「那篇貼文被批評為**刻意博眼球／博取關注**。」

attention-seeking = 刻意做某些事情來獲得別人的關注, 通常暗示程度過多或動機令人反感

16. **attentive** = carefully noticing/listening (人) — 專心的; 留心的

Practice 32

> “The students were quiet and **attentive**.”

「學生們很安靜, 而且都**專心留意**。」

Practice 33

> “Be **attentive** during the safety briefing.”

「安全講解期間要**仔細聽、保持專注**。」

attentive = 主動而仔細地把注意力放在所聽、所看或所做的事情上

17. **attentive = caring about someone's needs (服務／人際) — 細心周到的; 體貼的**

A second important adjective use.

Practice 34

> “The hotel staff were extremely **attentive**.”

「酒店職員非常**細心周到、照顧客人需要**。」

Practice 35

> “He is an **attentive** father.”

「他是一位**很細心、很留意孩子需要的父親**。」

attentive — caring = 主動留意別人的需要並給予細心照顧的

So:

> attentive student → 專心的學生

> attentive waiter → 服務周到的侍應

Same core concept, different Chinese translation.

18. **attentively = with careful attention — 專心地; 仔細地**

Practice 36

> “She listened **attentively**.”

「她**專心仔細地**聽著。」

Practice 37

> “He watched **attentively** as the technician explained the controls.”

「技術人員解釋操作方法時，他**很留心地**看著。」

attentively = 以高度留意、專心而不分心的方式

19. **inattentive** = not paying enough attention — 不專心的; 疏忽的

Practice 38

> “The driver appeared **inattentive**.”

「司機看起來**沒有集中注意力／有點疏忽**。」

Practice 39

> “An **inattentive** reader may miss the difference.”

「**不夠細心的讀者**可能會錯過這個差別。」

inattentive = 沒有把足夠注意力放在應該留意的事情上

20. **inattention** = failure/lack of attention — 不注意; 疏忽

Practice 40

> “The mistake was caused by **inattention**.”

「這個錯誤是因為**疏忽／沒有留心**造成的。」

Practice 41

> “A moment of **inattention** can cause an accident.”

「一瞬間的**分心或疏忽**也可能造成事故。」

****inattention = 沒有給予應有的注意力, 導致忽略重要資訊或事情****

21. ****attention (AI / machine learning) — 注意力機制; 注意力權重****

A useful modern technical meaning.

In machine learning, particularly neural networks and transformers, ****attention**** refers to a mechanism that lets a model assign different importance to different parts of its input when processing information.

Practice 42

> “Transformers use ****attention**** to relate different parts of a sequence.”

「Transformer 模型利用****注意力機制****建立序列不同部分之間的關係。」

Practice 43

> “The model assigns higher ****attention**** to relevant words.”

「模型會對相關字詞給予較高的****注意力權重****。」

****attention — AI = 模型在處理資訊時, 動態判斷不同輸入部分相對重要程度的一種計算機制****

This is genuinely distinct from human mental attention, although the technical term was inspired by that concept.

Important distinction: ****attention vs focus****

You already curated ****focus****.

****attention****

= the mental resource/awareness directed toward something.

****focus****

= concentrating that attention strongly on a particular target.

> “The noise caught my attention.”

「噪音引起了我的注意。」

> “I focused my attention on the report.”

「我把注意力集中在報告上。」

Something can **catch your attention** without you maintaining **focus** on it for very long.

Important distinction: **attention vs concentration**

attention

broader:

= noticing and mentally attending.

concentration

strong sustained mental effort.

> “The sign caught my attention.”

「牌子引起了我的注意。」

This does not mean deep concentration.

> “The task requires concentration.”

「這項工作需要高度專注。」

Important distinction: **catch attention vs pay attention**

catch someone's attention

the object causes someone to notice it.

> “The ad caught my attention.”

廣告 → 人

pay attention to something

the person deliberately focuses on the object.

> “I paid attention to the ad.”

人 → 廣告

This directional distinction is excellent for MCQs.

Important distinction: **attention vs interest**

attention

= mental noticing/focus.

interest

= desire to know more or involvement/enjoyment.

Something may:

> **catch your attention**

for a few seconds,

without:

> **holding your interest**

for very long.

Important distinction: **attention vs care**

They overlap in the “looking after” meaning.

attention

often emphasizes observation, service, or treatment.

care

is broader and can include long-term responsibility and concern.

> “The patient needs medical attention.”

「病人需要醫療處理。」

> “The patient needs long-term care.”

「病人需要長期照護。」

Not identical.

Important distinction: **attentive vs careful**

attentive

= actively paying attention to someone/something.

careful

= taking precautions to avoid mistakes/danger.

> “an attentive listener”

「專心的聽眾」

> “a careful driver”

「小心謹慎的司機」

A person can be attentive but still make a careless decision.

Important distinction: **attentive vs considerate**

attentive

= notices someone's needs and responds.

considerate

= thinks about how one's actions affect others.

> “The waiter was attentive.”

「侍應服務很周到。」

> “It was considerate of you to keep the noise down.”

「你降低音量，很替別人著想。」

They overlap in kindness contexts but are not identical.

Grammar/collocation note

Common patterns:

- * **pay attention to** something
- * **give attention to** something
- * **draw attention to** something
- * **call attention to** something
- * **catch someone's attention**
- * **attract attention**
- * **need/require attention**
- * **attention to detail**
- * **medical attention**
- * **full/undivided attention**

One useful expression:

> **undivided attention**

= **全部注意力／全神貫注**

> “The task needs your undivided attention.”

「這項工作需要你全神貫注。」

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

- * **attention — mental** = 注意力／關注
- * **catch someone's attention** = 吸引某人注意
- * **attract attention** = 引起注意
- * **pay attention to** = 留意／專心
- * **draw/call attention to** = 提請注意
- * **attention — consideration** = 關注／仔細處理
- * **attention to detail** = 對細節的重視
- * **attention — care/service** = 照料／服務
- * **medical attention** = 醫療處理
- * **attention — maintenance** = 檢查／維修處理
- * **Attention!** = 注意！／請注意！
- * **at attention** = 立正
- * **attentions** = 殷勤／追求／密集關注
- * **attention span** = 注意力持續時間
- * **attention-grabbing** = 吸睛的
- * **attention-seeking** = 刻意博取注意的
- * **attentive** = 專心的；細心周到的
- * **attentively** = 專心地
- * **inattentive** = 不專心／疏忽的
- * **inattention** = 疏忽／不注意
- * **attention — AI** = 注意力機制

Attend is of course historically and morphologically related, but we already curated **attend** earlier, so I'm deliberately not regenerating it here under our duplicate rule.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
attention — mental focus	人把感官、思考和精神集中在某個對象上的狀態
catch/attract attention	令某人開始注意某人／某事，將注意力轉向它
pay attention to	主動把注意力集中在某個對象，以免錯過重要資訊
draw/call attention to	有意令別人注意某項原本可能被忽略的事情
attention — consideration	對重要事情投入時間、思考和處理，以確保得到妥善處置
attention to detail	對細小但重要的資訊保持高度留意、避免錯漏的能力
attention — care/service	為滿足某人的需要而給予的照料、協助或服務
medical attention	由醫療人員提供的檢查、照顧或治療
attention — maintenance	對有問題的設備／情況進行必要檢查、維修或處理
Attention!	用來立即要求所有人集中注意的正式呼叫／警告

at attention	身體挺直、保持正式軍事立正姿勢	
attentions	對某人持續而明顯的殷勤、追求或密集關注	
attention span	一個人在注意力分散前能持續專注的時間長度	
attention-grabbing	特別能迅速吸引別人注意的	
attention-seeking	刻意透過行為來獲得他人關注的, 通常帶負面意味	
attentive — concentration	主動仔細留意所聽、所看或所做事情的	
attentive — caring	主動留意別人的需要並給予細心照顧的	
inattentive	沒有給予應有注意力、容易忽略重要事情的	
inattention	缺乏應有注意力而造成的分心／疏忽	
attention — AI	模型動態判斷不同輸入部分相對重要程度的計算機制	

For your original sentence

> “...so the ad immediately **caught my attention**.”

The exact meaning is:

attention = 當時我的注意力／關注焦點

and:

caught my attention = 廣告的內容或呈現方式令我立刻注意到它, 並把注意力轉向它

So the natural translation is:

> **「所以那則廣告立刻吸引了我的注意力／立即引起了我的注意。」**